



Department of Economics
Johns Hopkins University
Baltimore, MD 21218
dedwar65@jh.edu

November 24, 2025

Search Committee
Barney Barnett School of Business and Free Enterprise
Florida Southern College
Lakeland, FL 33801
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track Assistant/Associate Professor position in the Barney Barnett School of Business and Free Enterprise at Florida Southern College, beginning August 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Florida Southern College's AACSB-accredited business school, emphasis on engaged learning, and commitment to free enterprise and entrepreneurial values make this position a particularly appealing fit. I am excited by the opportunity to teach undergraduate and graduate courses in economics and finance—including *Principles of Microeconomics*, *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Money and Banking*, and *Managerial Finance*—and to contribute to a teacher-scholar environment where faculty are deeply involved with students inside and outside the classroom. The Barnett School's focus on applied business education and its encouragement of impactful scholarly activity align well with my research interests and my approach to mentoring students through data-driven problem-solving in economics and finance.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level

macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students “convince themselves” that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Florida Southern, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Microeconomics*, *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Money and Banking*, and *Managerial Finance*, as well as additional electives aligned with my research in macroeconomics, financial behavior, and quantitative methods. I also welcome the opportunity to participate in engaged-learning initiatives and mentor students pursuing applied research or professional development.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my empirical and computational expertise allows me to (i) integrate real-world financial and economic data into coursework, (ii) support engaged learning and applied projects consistent with the Barnett School’s mission, and (iii) maintain a research agenda that supports excellent teaching and contributes to the broader discipline. I am enthusiastic about joining a business school that values applied scholarship, collegiality, and close student-faculty interaction.

I would be honored to join the Barney Barnett School of Business and Free Enterprise at Florida Southern College. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your school at your convenience.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards